Sample 1

Application Letter for a Working Group

(Letterhead)
January 22, 2002

Dr. Melba Ripley
The School of Architecture University of Louisiana
100 Webber Hall
Baton Rouge, LA70814

Dear Dr.Ripley,

I am a researcher at School of Materials Engineering,Purdue University. I have devoted nearly five years to the study of how inexpensive housing can be made of native materials in Third World countries; I was intrigued by the recent accomplishments of you and your students in designing and providing "instant" housing to victims of the recent hurricane in Central America. Therefore, I wish to learn about construction techniques of developing new structures in your working group for six months, preferably during April through September.

During the past three years, I have been an assistant to Dr. Graham Benson who has shared the rostrum with you at many academic and global conferences on housing. Together we, along with a group of students, have spent the past two summers showing people in South Central Africa how to mix a specially prepared binder developed by our research lab with local materials to make durable homes in a matter of days. I would truly like to have the opportunity to do research work in your group so as to learn state-of-the-art technology in housing-building materials.

I would greatly appreciate it if you could send me more information about application at your earliest convenience.

Sincerely yours,
Thomas Lamb

Self-intro
Research area
Interest in the program
Purpose of the letter
Related experience
Confirm the wish
Requesting info

Sample 2

Application Letter for a Graduate Program

Department of Physics
Nanjing University
22 Hankou Road, Nanjing 210093
P. R. China
November 3, 2006

Mrs. Elizabeth Williams
Graduate Admissions Office University Office
Wellington Square Oxford, OX12JD
UK

Dear Mrs.Elizabeth Williams,

Self-intro

I am a student in the Department of Physics,expecting to graduate with a bachelor's degree in July next year. I am very much interested in pursuing a master's degree in Particle Physics at the Particle Physics Department of Oxford University. From my review of graduate programs and discussion with my professors, I find that Oxford University has the largest particle physics group in the UK, with a large academic and support staff. I intend to enter in the autumn of 2007.

Interest in the program

Reason of his choice

Purpose of the letter

In my undergraduate years, I have worked hard. As you can see from my curriculum vitae, my GPA in major courses is 3.8/4.0 and I have remained top 5% of about 100 students. I have also worked with Dr. Liu Wei and Professor Luo Lei on research topics like the applied physics at the enterprise level. Because of my excellence in study and research, I have been awarded scholarships three times. In addition, I am well-prepared linguistically to further my studies in the UK. My IELTS is 7.5 and my GRE is 130.

Academic performance

Related experience

scholarships

Linguistic ability

I would be grateful if you would send me the application forms for admission and financial support at your earliest convenience. Thank you for your consideration.

Requesting info

I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Sincerely yours,
Lin Pengpeng

Sample 3

Application Letter for Attending a Conference

(Letter head)
March 15, 2007

Dear Dr.Nelson,

Self-intro

I am a Ph. D. candidate in School of Environmental Science and Engineering of Shandong University, P. R. China. I have heard from Prof. Wang Dongliang that the International Conference on Cities and Conservation will be held in the University of California, September 1-5,2007. I am writing to you about the possibility of attending the forthcoming conference.

Source of the info

Purpose of the letter

I am currently doing research in Prof. Wang's working group on water pollution prevention technology and water reuse, the area that I have always been interested in. I believe that attending such a conference will provide me with a very good opportunity to exchange ideas and expertise with attendees from different parts of the world and, more importantly, to learn from them.

Research area

I would be grateful if you could send me more information about application form and financial support.

Requesting info

I look forward to your early reply.

Sincerely yours,
Wei Lin